

Research

The career decision of information systems people *

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This study examines the relationships between career decisions and directions and a set of independent variables including job title, demographic variables, role stressors, boundary spanning activities, perceived job characteristics, and career outcomes for 348 IS employees. Results show that the majority had already defined specific jobs they would like to hold in the near future. They were also able to define four directions for their future careers: IS technical, IS management, business, and consultant. Results show that career decisions and directions are related to some of the independent variables. IS employees in each of the four career directions could be further categorized into groups on the basis of similar characteristics. Implications of these findings are discussed.

Keywords: IS personnel; Career paths; Career decisions; Management of IS personnel

1. Introduction

Lately both practitioners and researchers have shown increased concern over the career issues of information systems (IS) people. Two significant



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